

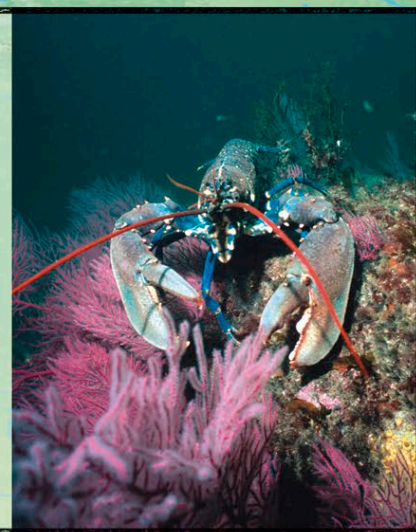
ARCTIC OCEAN

Norwegian Sea

Warm ocean currents flowing up from the tropical Atlantic into the Norwegian Sea help keep waters ice-free, so lobsters live as far north as the Arctic Circle.

Life on the seabed

A lobster needs water to help support its weighty body, which is far too heavy for the lobster to move around on rocky shores or beaches. Lobsters mostly crawl across the seabed, where they live in crevices or burrows. When needed, they escape by quickly swimming backwards. Even a big lobster might be swept away by strong currents in deeper water, so they don't go too far offshore.



Coastal crustacean

Like many other marine animals, the European lobster stays mainly in coastal seas. Lobsters are fished for food, but despite some local overfishing, especially in the North Sea, the overall population is stable.

Black Sea

Rivers flowing into the cool Black Sea make it less salty than the ocean. European lobsters can survive here, but in fewer numbers and only in western areas.

Baltic Sea

EUROPE

Black Sea

Crete

Mediterranean Sea

Salty environment

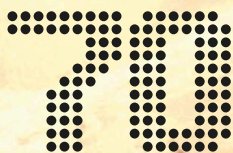
A warm climate evaporates water from the Mediterranean Sea and makes it slightly saltier than the Atlantic Ocean. Lobsters can take these conditions, and range widely across this region.

Eastern Mediterranean

The Mediterranean Sea reaches a depth of over 16,400 ft (5,000 m) in the middle. Lobsters keep to shallower coastal waters, ranging as far east as the Greek island of Crete.

AFRICA

FEMALE EUROPEAN LOBSTERS CAN LIVE UP TO THE AGE OF



OVERFISHING IN THE NORTH SEA HAS MADE LOBSTER NUMBERS THERE DROP BY

